

Sally (Shao-Yu) Tsai

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EDUCATION

Harvard University, Harvard Kennedy School

Cambridge, MA

Master in Public Administration in International Development (MPA/ID) Sep 2025 – Jun 2027

- Relevant coursework: Advanced Microeconomic Analysis (API-110), Advanced Macroeconomic Analysis (API-120), Advanced Quantitative Methods (API-210), Politics of Development (DPI-410)
- Working papers: “The Security Premium” (2026, w/ Wang & Sanchez); “VAT Pass-Through in Philippine Pharmaceutical Markets” (2026, w/ Vega, PCC/UEA)

University of Toronto

Toronto, Canada

B.A. in Political Science and Public Policy, High Distinction — GPA: 3.7/4.0 Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

- University of Toronto Admission Scholarship (full first-year tuition); Dean’s List 2022–2024

RESEARCH AND POLICY PAPERS

“The Security Premium: Why Taiwan Maintains the World’s Most Restrictive Policy toward Chinese Electric Vehicles” (2026)

- Built a 193-country dataset coding EV policy restrictiveness on a 0–3 scale; developed a 2×2 typology (ICE industry size × EV adoption level) to generate quadrant-specific predictions and isolate the security channel; estimated ordered logit (M1–M7) against the Grossman–Helpman baseline, showing Taiwan is the largest positive residual; applied synthetic control to quantify a 29% production divergence post-2016 and a leave-one-out cross-validation giving Taiwan only 4% probability of maximum restriction absent the security channel

Brazil Primary Health Financing: Previne Brasil Program Evaluation (2025–2026)

- Applied difference-in-differences with event study methods across 5,500+ Brazilian municipalities to assess how federal capitation reform affected primary care infrastructure and health outcomes

“VAT Pass-Through in Philippine Pharmaceutical Markets: Evidence from the TRAIN Act” (2026, with Carlos Vega, PCC/UEA)

- Lead-authored working paper using IQVIA MIDAS product-level panel data (N=44,339 observations); estimated DiD, triple-difference by license type, and synthetic control; found zero pass-through to patients — treated prices rose 2.3% while firms absorbed the VAT exemption as margin expansion, with retail volumes falling 20%, implying a double welfare loss in the retail channel

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

African Development Bank — Africa Legal Support Facility (ALSF)

Remote

Consultant (Intern)

Jun 2026 – Sep 2026

- Developing and co-coordinating to build and pilot a Regulatory Framework Assessment Diagnostic Toolkit for member states, finalizing assessment templates, scoring criteria, and output frameworks
- Conducting desk-based country diagnostic to a pilot African country; producing country scorecard, institutional map, and draft action plan; finalizing the RFA Methodology Guide for AfDB operational use across future country applications

Philippine Competition Commission, Economics Office

Manila, Philippines

Economics Intern

May 2026 – Jul 2026

- Lead-authored working paper on VAT pass-through in Philippine pharmaceutical markets using IQVIA data; estimated DiD and triple-difference models identifying zero consumer pass-through and

a 20% retail volume decline following the 2019 TRAIN Act VAT exemption

- Conducting quantitative analysis of market structure and industrial policy in the Philippines

Legislator's Office, Democratic Progressive Party (Rep. Rosalia Wu)

Taipei, Taiwan

Research and Policy Assistant

Jun 2020 – Aug 2024

- Conducted research and data analysis supporting legislative policy development on cross-strait economic, industrial, and trade policy; prepared briefing materials and risk assessments on political impact of ongoing initiatives
- Managed data-driven communications strategy, achieving a 47% increase in public engagement; reorganized media content workflows and automated speech recording management to improve operational efficiency

The Taiwan Gazette, Global Taiwan Studies Program, University of Toronto

Toronto,

Canada

Assistant Editor

Nov 2022 – Jun 2025

- Automated focus group research logistics, achieving a 73% increase in engagement; produced policy analysis on cross-strait political transitions and Taiwan's international economic position
- Developed research reports supporting editorial decision-making; coordinated project management processes across research and publication outputs

Asian Institute, Munk School of Global Affairs and Public Policy, University of Toronto

Toronto, Canada

Research Assistant

Mar 2023 – Sep 2023

- Organized and led a 10-day research trip coordinating logistics with local partner institutions and ensuring systematic data collection
- Synthesized research on Taiwan's socio-political transitions into academic reports and public outputs

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

Taiwanese Students Association, University of Toronto

Toronto, Canada

President (2023–24); Marketing Executive (2022–23)

Sep 2022 – May 2024

- Led 35-person executive team; grew organizational revenue by 98% and expanded programming for 200+ international students

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Methods: Causal inference (DiD, staggered adoption, RD, IV, panel fixed effects, event study); ordered logit; synthetic control; OLS with robust SEs; growth accounting; political economy analysis

Software: R (tidyverse, ggplot2, MASS, Synth, knitr, Quarto), L^AT_EX, Excel (Macros, Pivot Tables)

Languages: Mandarin (native), English (native)